

This is a screenshot of a PDF file opened in Notepad++. Perhaps only a seasoned developer who has worked a lot on PDF might be able to recognise it! You can take any random section of XML data and get some information out of it.

So let's start with the basic rules of XML. Here, we will focus only on the basic features required to make a valid XML file suitable for use in AJAX.

2.2 The XML structure

XML is a tag-based language — the data that you need to represent has to be grouped and organised within tags. It is very easy to represent structured data in XML. Let's consider an example of data we use every day, and see how it can possibly be represented in XML.

2.2.1 A simple to-do list

```
<todo>
  <task duration="12mins" completed="No">
    Get Milk
  </task>

  <task duration="30mins" completed="Yes">
    Dry-clean Rug
  </task>

  <task duration="5hrs" completed="No">
    Complete report
  </task>
</todo>
```

2.2.2 Contact data

```
<addressbook>
  <contact>
    <name>
      John Doe
    </name>
    <phone type="home">
      01122245656
    </phone>
```